The Sādhana of the Yellow Perfection of Wisdom

Pītavarṇaprajñāpāramitāsādhana · Toh 3543 · Derge Tengyur
ཞལ་རབ་ཀ་ཀྲི་རལ་ཏ་ཕྱུན་མ་སངས་མདོ་སྡེ་བཅས

The Means of Accomplishment of the Yellow Perfection of Wisdom, known in Sanskrit as the Pītavarṇa Prajñāpāramitā Sādhana, is a short meditation manual devoted to the goddess Prajñāpāramitā, the Perfection of Wisdom personified as a female deity in her yellow form. After paying homage to the noble lady Perfection of Wisdom, it guides the practitioner through visualizing a moon arising from the syllable a, a variegated lotus born from a yellow syllable dhīḥ, and a yellow syllable haṃ encircled by the vowels and consonants of the Sanskrit alphabet. It goes on to describe the eight offering goddesses, Lāsyā, Mālā, Nṛtyā, Gītā, Puṣpā, Dhūpā, Dīpā and Gandhā, and the emergence of a moon of wisdom bearing a lotus and a volume of the Perfection of Wisdom scriptures, from which the deity takes form. The text is Toh 3543 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the large collection of tantric sādhanas, the practical ritual and meditation texts for invoking and identifying with enlightened deities.

In the language of India: pītabarṇaprajñāpāramitāsādhanaṃ. In the language of Tibet: The Means of Accomplishment of the Yellow Perfection of Wisdom.

Homage to the noble lady Perfection of Wisdom.

Following the rite taught earlier, one should meditate on a moon arisen from the syllable a. On it is a variegated lotus arisen from a yellow syllable dhīḥ. On the lotus is a yellow syllable haṃ, encircled by the sixteen vowels beginning with a, and outside these it is encircled by the thirty-two letters beginning with ka.

Then come the eight yoginīs, named Lāsyā, Mālā, Nṛtyā, Gītā, Puṣpā, Dhūpā, Dīpā and Gandhā.

All of these are completely transformed, and from them rises the moon of wisdom, shining with brilliant light. On it is a lotus, and on that a volume of the Perfection of Wisdom. On that is a second moon disc, and on that a second volume.

All of these are completely transformed, and from them arises the Blessed Lady, the Perfection of Wisdom. Her body is yellow, with one face and two arms. She wears a crown of the five Tathāgatas and makes the mudrā of teaching the Dharma. She sits on a variegated lotus and a moon, adorned with

every garment and ornament. At her right and left sides she holds volumes of the Perfection of Wisdom resting on blue lotuses (utpalas).

The mantra is: oṃ āḥ dhīḥ hūṃ svāhā.

At the forehead is a yellow oṃ, at the throat a white āḥ, at the heart a yellow dhīḥ, and at the navel a black hūṃ. At the time of mantra recitation one should contemplate these four syllables accordingly. So it is taught.

The Means of Accomplishment of the Yellow Perfection of Wisdom is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The eight offering yoginīs are given here by their usual Sanskrit names, Lāsyā, Mālā, Nṛtyā, Gītā, Puṣpā, Dhūpā, Dīpā and Gandhā. The Tibetan translates these names literally as the Graceful One, the Garland One, the Dancer, the Singer, the Flower One, the Incense One, the Lamp One and the Scent One.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.